

Travel and Expense Policy

Version 2.1 · Effective 1 April 2026 · Owner: Finance

1. Purpose and principles

This policy explains what you can claim, how much, and how to claim it. Spend company money as carefully as you would spend your own. Expenses must be business-related, reasonable and supported by a valid receipt. Claims are submitted in the Expense Portal.

2. Submission and deadlines

- Submit claims within **30 days** of the expense date. Older claims are rejected unless Finance approves an exception in writing.
- Every claim needs an itemised receipt. Card slips alone are not enough.
- Approved claims are reimbursed with the next salary cycle. Claims approved after the 20th of a month are paid in the following cycle.
- You can track claim status in the Expense Portal. A rejected claim shows the reason and can be resubmitted once, within 7 days.

3. Receipts and GST

For domestic expenses, receipts must show the vendor name, date, amount and itemisation. For hotels, flights and conferences, ask for a GST invoice in the name of **Zomato Limited** with the company GSTIN, so the company can claim input tax credit. For expenses under ₹200 where a receipt is not available, such as an auto fare, you may sign a self-declaration up to a total of ₹1,000 per month.

4. Advances and the corporate card

Employees who travel often may request a **cash advance** of up to 80% of the estimated trip cost, approved by the manager. An advance must be settled within 10 days of returning from the trip. Unsettled advances are recovered from salary.

Managers and above who travel regularly can get a corporate credit card. Card use is for business expenses only. Statements are reconciled monthly in the Expense Portal, and unreconciled spend older than 30 days is blocked.

5. Meals

Situation	Limit
Working meal while travelling, Tier 1 city	₹1,500 per day
Working meal while travelling, other cities	₹1,000 per day
Team dinner (late work, with manager approval)	₹600 per person
Team lunch or celebration (quarterly, per team)	₹800 per person
Client meal	₹2,500 per person

Client meals can be reimbursed up to ₹2,500 per person. List every attendee and the business purpose on the claim. Alcohol is not reimbursable. A client meal needs a receipt with the itemised bill, and the claim must be submitted within 30 days. Meals within your own city on a normal working day are not reimbursable.

Meal credits from your benefits cannot be claimed again as an expense.

6. Domestic travel

Item	Rule
Flights	Economy class. Book at least 7 days ahead where possible, through the Travel Desk portal.
Trains	AC 2-tier or Vande Bharat chair car for journeys over 6 hours.
Hotels, Tier 1 city	Up to ₹7,500 per night including taxes
Hotels, other cities	Up to ₹5,000 per night including taxes
Local transport	Metro, cab or auto. Prefer pooled or metered options.
Personal car	₹12 per km, with a log of start and end points
Two-wheeler	₹5 per km

All domestic flights and hotels must be booked through the Travel Desk portal. Bookings made outside the portal are not reimbursed unless the Travel Desk was unavailable and Finance approved the exception. Tier 1 cities are Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Chennai, Kolkata, Hyderabad and Pune.

7. International travel

International trips need approval from your department head and the Finance Controller at least 21 days ahead. Fly economy; business class is allowed only for flights over 10 hours and with CFO approval. A daily allowance covers meals and local transport, so you do not claim them separately.

Region	Daily allowance	Hotel cap per night
Southeast Asia	USD 60	USD 150
Middle East	USD 70	USD 180
Europe and UK	USD 90	USD 220
USA and Canada	USD 100	USD 250

Foreign currency expenses are converted at the rate on the date of the expense. Buy travel insurance through the Travel Desk; it is paid by the company.

8. Work-related allowances

Item	Limit	Notes
Work-from-home setup	₹15,000 one time	Desk, chair, monitor. Keep the invoice.
Phone and internet	₹1,000 per month	Submit the monthly bill
Fitness or gym	₹1,500 per month	Membership receipt required
Learning and conferences	₹40,000 per year	Manager approval before you pay
Books and subscriptions	Within learning budget	Professional use only
Relocation	Up to ₹75,000 for goods	For approved transfers only

9. Approvals

Claim amount	Approver
Up to ₹10,000	Direct manager
₹10,001 to ₹50,000	Department head
Above ₹50,000	Finance Controller

You cannot approve your own claim or a claim from a person who reports to you in a way that creates a conflict. Claims for a manager are approved by the next level up.

10. Expenses that are not reimbursable

- Personal entertainment, fines and traffic penalties
- Alcohol, except where a client contract requires it and Finance has approved it in advance
- Upgrades chosen for comfort, such as a premium seat or a suite
- Expenses without a receipt, other than under the self-declaration rule
- Family members' travel, or personal items bought on a business trip
- Gifts to colleagues, except a team celebration within the meal limits
- Pre-approved items claimed twice, for example under both the learning budget and a corporate card

11. Audit and policy violations

Finance audits a sample of claims every quarter, plus every claim above ₹50,000. Misrepresenting an expense, submitting a false receipt or claiming the same cost twice is a violation of the code of conduct. Consequences range from recovery of the amount and a written warning to termination of employment. Accidental errors that are reported promptly are treated as corrections, not violations.

12. Common questions

Can I expense a client dinner?

Yes. Client meals are reimbursable up to ₹2,500 per person with an itemised receipt, the attendee list and the business purpose, submitted within 30 days.

What if I lose a receipt?

Ask the vendor for a duplicate. If that is impossible, submit a self-declaration for amounts under ₹200, within the monthly limit of ₹1,000. Larger amounts need Finance approval.

My trip was cancelled after I paid. What now?

Claim any non-refundable cost with the cancellation proof and a note from your manager.

13. Contacts

Write to finance-help@zomato.example. For urgent travel issues, call the 24x7 travel desk listed in the Expense Portal.